

Republic of Iraq

**General Directorate of Educational Planning
National Report of the Republic of Iraq**

Progress towards achieving Goal 4 of the 2030 Sustainable Development Goals

**prepared by
General Directorate of Educational Planning**

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Introduction by His Excellency the Minister

In the last four decades of its history, Iraq has confronted great challenges that have affected buildings, resources and institutions. There is no doubt that this has left its shadow over the educational process and affected the education sector a great deal. Iraqi educational institutions have faced internal and external challenges that have impacted the efficiency of institutional performance and seriously affected the provision of educational services, including a shortage of school buildings and the need for existing buildings to be rehabilitated or rebuilt, especially in the governorates affected by the conflict with ISIS. With the increased interest in education, progress has been made in net enrollment rates at all levels of education and in gender parity due to the high enrolment rates of girls. A number of measures are needed to improve the provision of educational services to support the human capital that supports the economy and its growth, labour productivity and the preparation of young people active in the labour market.

Iraq has freely committed to achieving the 2030 Sustainable Development Goals, including Goal 4, quality education, and Iraq's Vision 2030, which focuses on the priority of human development. This is the top development priority and its goals are a quality, inclusive educational system, a road map outlining the features of a developmental future to achieve its goals and aspirations and the ambitions of its children to keep pace with the global development movement in the fields of sustainable development through its plans, programmes and strategies in order to enable the country to mobilize available resources in an optimal manner to respond to the aspirations of all so that no one is left behind, and in a way that guarantees the achievement of the desired hopes and a better future for the generations to come.

Executive summary

In order to invest in human capital and transform its loss over the past four decades as a result of the wars and crises to which Iraq has been exposed into development gains, interest and investment in education have increased in order to provide a better educational environment, rehabilitate and reconstruct school buildings, especially in the affected governorates, and to use education as a tool to guarantee social cohesion, peace-building and active civic awareness. Work has been done to make Sustainable Development Goal 4 a comprehensive framework for the process of developing the education sector in Iraq in a way that enables educational institutions to be guided by the targets and indicators as measurements of the progress achieved and in a way that guarantees access to educational opportunities for all without neglecting any group or section of society.

The first section of the report gives an overview of the demographic, economic and social conditions and the state of education in Iraq; the second discusses national perspectives on Goal 4, while the third points to the progress made towards Goal 4 and the targets through indicators and programmes for the period 2015-2019, and the challenges.

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Section One: Introduction and context

Overview of Iraq

Demographic, economic and social conditions and educational situation

Introduction

Education is considered a basic social service in Iraq. The education sector is subject to an integrated system of legislation, Acts and regulations that define the work of educational institutions. Under this system, the Ministry of Education is responsible for education policy, planning and supplies. Primary education is compulsory in Iraq and education is free at all levels. This is guaranteed by the Iraqi Constitution of 2005.

- Article 34(1) of the Iraqi Constitution provides: "Education is a fundamental factor in the progress of society and is a right guaranteed by the State. Primary education is compulsory and the State guarantees that it will combat illiteracy".
- Article 34(2) provides: "Free education at all stages is the right of all Iraqis".
- Article 34(4) provides: "Private and public education shall be guaranteed and regulated by law".
- Article 7 of the draft Iraqi declaration of human rights 2004 provides: "The State guarantees the right to education for all. It shall be compulsory at the basic stage, free at all stages and have the aim of fully developing the human personality and promoting and respecting human rights".

Demographic and social situation

According to the population statistics for 2018, the population of Iraq is about 34 million. Males account for 51% of the population and females for 49%. Baghdad is the most populous governorate, with 21% of the total population, followed by Nineveh and Basra governorates.

Arabic and Kurdish are both official languages under the Iraqi Constitution. About 85% of Iraqis speak Arabic as their mother tongue; Kurdish is spoken as a mother tongue by about 21%, while Turkmen, Syriac and other languages are spoken by 3%. Turkmen is the third most commonly used language as a mother tongue in Iraq. Eastern Aramaic is also used by some Christian, Assyrian, Chaldean, Syriac Orthodox, and Catholic populations, in addition to the Armenian language of the Armenian minority.

Iraq has a Muslim majority accounting for about 95% of the population, while Christians, Sabians and Yazidis make up about 5%.

Economic situation

1. Indicators of GDP at current prices rose by 2.1% and at constant prices by 9.6% in 2016 compared to 2015. This was reflected in average per capita GDP at constant prices, which increased by 6.7% in the same period.
2. Crude oil indicators: The Iraqi economy depends heavily on oil; indeed, its economy is primarily oil. However, oil is not the only resource and industry began in 1952. Crude oil activity achieved a remarkable increase in quantities of production of 19.9% in 2016

compared to 2015. Quantities produced increased and oil exports rose by 10.1% in 2016 compared to 2015.

3. Agriculture: The agricultural sector is an important part of the Iraqi economy, the most important products being seeds, grains, dates, vegetables and fruits. The agricultural areas are concentrated around the rivers Tigris and Euphrates and their tributaries scattered throughout the country.
4. Industry: The industries in Iraq are varied and Iraqi industry is characterized by quality, despite the circumstances that the country has gone through. Industries include construction materials, petrochemicals, tobacco and leather. The industrial indicators for 2016 show that there were 566 operating establishments.
5. Minerals: In addition to oil and natural gas, there are large quantities of phosphates and sulphur in Iraqi territory, and also uranium and red mercury.
6. External trade indicators: Total exports fell by 19.5% in 2016 compared to 2015, while total imports fell by 25.7%.

Educational situation and structure of the education system

In Iraq, children enrol in kindergarten at four to five years old, primary school at six years, lower secondary school at the age of 12, and higher secondary school at the age of 15. The primary stage and the secondary stage each has six grades. The school year usually runs from September until June the following year.

Pre-primary education is important for children's preparedness for school, and early childhood development is a priority for the Government of Iraq: it has developed a strategy on early childhood development because of the limited coverage of pre-primary education, the enrolment rate for children aged four to five years being 11% in the academic year 2018-2019. The enrolment rates for primary, lower secondary and upper secondary were 94%, 57% and 28%, respectively.

The indicators of the state of schools show that there is a great shortage of school buildings and a doubling up of schools (i.e. two schools working in a single building), in addition to student overcrowding in classrooms. In the academic year 2018-2019, there was a shortfall of 8,093 schools, while the number of students per class was 37, 42 and 39 in primary, lower secondary and upper secondary schools, respectively.

Coordination mechanism for follow-up and implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development

In order to strive at the national level to create an institutional framework to follow up the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (Agenda 2030) at the federal and local levels, several follow-up and implementation committees have been formed:

1. The Follow-up Cell: Formed under Order No. 19 of 2016 and chaired by the Minister of Planning, its membership is composed undersecretaries of ministries, representatives of civil society organizations, representatives of the private sector and experts from universities. Its role is to direct programmes and policies to achieve the Goals and submit them to the Cabinet for approval.
2. The National Sustainable Development Committee: It is chaired by the Minister of Planning and all relevant ministries are represented on it. Its mission is to monitor the Sustainable Development Goals and prepare a national report on what has been achieved through its specialized teams.

3. Sustainable development committees in the governorates: These are local committees chaired by the governor, with the assistant technical governor as his deputy. Their mission is to monitor the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and indicators at the governorate level and submit reports to the National Sustainable Development Committee.

Section Two

National perspectives on Goal 4 of the Sustainable Development Goals (education)

1. Iraq's development Vision 2030, "Empowered Iraqis in a safe country and unified society with a diversified economy, sustainable environment, justice and good governance", is Iraq's map to look to the future goals to be achieved. It sets out several national priorities, the first of which is human development. One of its goals is a "high quality and inclusive education system" to invest in human capital and improve educational service delivery, strengthen institutional and governmental capacities and increase access to training in the short, medium and long term in order to provide a better learning environment, and to ensure educational services for children affected by conflict and provide flexible options for refugees and displaced persons in terms of school enrolment procedures and exams.
2. The government programme contains a third focus – sustainable development and social services – and priority 4 of the programme is to provide a sound educational and school environment in accordance with international standards and focusing on special education, adolescents and the gifted.
3. The National Development Plan 2018-2022 for Education integrates the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and contains goals for the education sector, including providing opportunities for education for all and a set of awareness-raising goals to upgrade the status of education, which come under Sustainable Development Goal 4.
4. The National Strategy for Education 2022 includes basic goals and principles consistent with the Goal 4 targets in education that ensures equal opportunities for education, high-quality education, and education that contributes to comprehensive development and meets the requirements of society.
5. The Strategy for the Alleviation of Poverty in Iraq 2018-2022 includes several activities aimed at achieving the Goal 4, "Education 2030", and the targets, including opening technical departments and workshops in schools in poor areas, rehabilitating existing schools, focusing on girls' schools, workshops to ensure the provision of basic education to poor displaced children, and the training of teachers in rural areas. It also includes programmes aimed at eradicating illiteracy in poor areas and creating and equipping community centres to eradicate illiteracy and teach life skills.

Section Three

Progress made towards Goal 4 and the targets in the period 2015 to 2019

Sustainable Development Goal 4: Ensure inclusive and quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.

Target 4.1: By 2030, ensure that all girls and boys complete free, equitable and quality primary and secondary education leading to relevant and effective learning outcomes

1. Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.1

Target 4.1	Net enrolment rate (%) by level and gender
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Educational level	Males	Females	Total
Primary	95	93	94
Lower secondary	57	57	57
Upper secondary	26	30	28
High school	62	55	58

Indicator 4.1.1 There is no participation in international studies or tests to assess student education (PISA – TIMSS – PIRLS). Therefore, from the official statistical reports for the 2018-2019 academic year issued by the Statistics Department of the Ministry of Education, we list the value of the indicator below:

Indicator 4.1.1	Proportion (%) of children and young people achieving at least a minimum proficiency level in reading and mathematics		
Grade	Males	Females	Total
(a) Grade 2 of primary school	87.5	89.7	88.6
(a) Grade 3 of primary school	86.6	90	88.3
(b) Grade 6 of primary school	80.4	86.8	83.6
(c) Grade 3 of lower secondary school	39	63	51

Indicator 4.1.2 – Organization of a national examination to assess the learning of a representative sample of: (a) second or third grade; (b) at the end of the primary school; and (c) at the end of lower secondary school.

On 24 April, 2019, the Ministry of Education, in cooperation with UNICEF and Cambridge University experts, held a national mathematics and science examination for fourth-year primary school pupils, first, to identify and evaluate their level of learning and, second, to give educational and teaching staff experience and preparation to participate in TIMSS. The study sample consisted of 320 primary schools, 120 in Baghdad governorate and 200 in the rest of the governorates. Of the 12,663 male and female students who were to participate in the test, 11,966 did so, a participation rate of 94.5%. The test questions for mathematics and science included TIMSS questions.

Size of selected sample by gender			Pass rate (%)	
Males	Females	Total	Mathematics	Science
6 525	6 138	12 663	39.5	34.1

Indicator 4.1.3 Total admission rate to the last grade of primary school and at the end of lower secondary school.

Indicator 4.1.3 Gross enrolment rate by gender (%)					
Primary grade 6			Lower secondary grade 3		
Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total
102	92	97	108	81	95

Indicator 4.1.4: Primary school, lower secondary and upper secondary school completion rates.

The reason for the decrease in the success rates is the high repetition rates, in addition to the dropout rates, as shown in the table below.

Indicator 4.1.4									
Level	Pass rates (%)			Repetition rate (%)			Dropout rate (%)		
	Males	Females	Total	Males	Females	Total	Males	Females	Total
Primary	81.4	82.5	83.2	16.5	12.6	14.7	2.1	2.1	2.1
Lower secondary	62.3	75.1	67.8	35.1	21.9	29.5	2.6	3	2.8
Upper secondary	65.7	76.9	71	32.8	21.5	27.4	1.5	1.6	1.6

Indicator 4.1.5: Percentage of young people of official primary school age, lower secondary school age and upper secondary school age who are out of school.

Indicator 4.1.5	Percentage of young people out of school by level of education		
Level	Males	Females	Total
Primary	5	7	6
Lower secondary	43	43	43
Upper secondary	72	70	72
High school	38	46	42

Indicator 4.1.6: Percentage of children older than their grade at the primary level and in the first stage of secondary school.

Indicator 4.1.6	Percentage of children older than their grade		
Level	Males	Females	Total
Primary	15	12	14

Lower secondary	42	24	33
Upper secondary	22	17	19
High school	13	9	11

Indicator 4.1.7: Number of years of education (a) that are free, (b) that are compulsory in the primary and secondary stages under legal frameworks.

Indicator 4.1.7	Number of years of education that are	
	(a) Free (primary and secondary education)	(b) Compulsory (primary) under legal frameworks
	12	6

2. Programmes and projects implemented relating to target 4.1

1. Implementation of the educational diversification system at the upper secondary stage from the fifth scientific grade, dividing science study into life sciences and applied sciences.
2. Implementation of the courses system in the **uncompleted classes** of lower and upper secondary schools.
3. Implementation of the attempts system.
4. Implementation of the fast-track system for outstanding students in the fifth grade of primary school and the second and fifth grades of secondary school by preparing special tests to measure mental ability and achievement for candidate students to whom the screening regulations apply.
5. Implementation of the central nutrition project by the World Food Programme (WFP), covering 11 governorates in 11 districts: Nineveh, Salah al-Din, Kirkuk, Diyala, Wasit Al-Diwaniyah, Muthanna, Maysan, Dhi Qar, Basra and Anbar. The number of primary school students covered by the project was 322,000 male and female students, distributed over 1,060 schools.
6. Implementation of projects regarding curricula:
 - Science and mathematics development project under the supervision of UNESCO.
 - Teaching scientific subjects in schools where students have excellent English, starting from the first grade of lower secondary school.
 - Preparation of the unified curriculum for science, social and Arabic language subjects in lower secondary school.
 - Preparation of a new English language curriculum for all levels.
7. Child-friendly schools project supported by UNICEF provides a safe and attractive learning environment suitable for children to learn, express their opinions and participate in activities, and psychological and other support for the child.
8. Regarding quality management:

- Establishment of quality standards for instructors, teachers, supervisors and management.
- Preparation of the quality manual and the general review programme for the success rates for the past three years.

9. Regarding educational television:

- Broadcast of live and recorded educational lessons for school curricula, for all academic levels, for **completed and uncompleted** classes, and for various specializations.
- Recording of educational modules, which are lessons for teachers on a mechanism explaining and implementing the study plan.
- Printing educational lessons for the curricula of the completed classes and distributing them free of charge to general directorates of education, students, supervisors and parents, as part of the National Campaign to Eliminate Private Lessons.
- Production of scientific, cultural and artistic programmes.

Target 4.2 By 2030, ensure that all girls and boys have access to quality early childhood development, care and pre-primary education so that they are ready for primary education.

1. Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.2.

Indicator 4.2.1 Proportion of children aged 24-59 months who are developmentally on track in health, learning and psychosocial well-being, by sex

Males	Females	Total
67%	63%	65%

Indicator 4.2.2 - Participation rate in organized learning (one year before the official primary entry age), by sex

Indicator 4.2.2	Participation rate in organized learning (one year before the official primary entry age), by sex		
Kindergarten	Males	Females	Total
	11	11	11

Indicator 4.2.3 - Percentage of children under 5 years of age who live in a stimulating home learning environment

Males	Females	Total
43.6	45.3	44.4

Indicator 4.2.4 - Gross enrolment ratio in (a) pre-primary education (b) early childhood development institutions.

Indicator 4.2.4	Gross enrolment ratio in (a) pre-primary education (b) early childhood development institutions		
Kindergarten	Males	Females	Total
	11	11	11

Indicator 4.2.5 - The number of years of (a) free (b) compulsory pre-primary education guaranteed by legal frameworks

Indicator 4.2.5	Number of years of pre-primary education, 2018-2019 academic year	
	(a) Free	(b) Compulsory
	2 years	Pre-primary is not compulsory

2. Programmes and projects implemented relating to target 4.2

1. Opening more government and private kindergartens to accommodate the enrolment of children through encouraging parents to send their children to kindergarten.
2. Holding seminars with the participation of parents and the local community to raise awareness of and educate about the importance of early childhood and pre-primary education.
3. Preparation of an early childhood development strategy to devise an early childhood development curriculum and teacher training to provide services for four and five-year-olds.
4. Holding workshops on pre-primary education for kindergarten supervisors in developed countries.

Target 4.3 - By 2030, ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university

1. Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.3 (vocational education and training)

Indicator 4.3.1 - Participation rate of youth and adults in formal and non-formal education and training in the previous 12 months, by sex

Males	Females	Total
39%	35%	37%

Indicator 4.3.2

Indicator 4.3.2	Net enrolment rate (%) in higher education by gender, 2017-2018					
	Governmental education			Private education		
	Males	Females	Total	Males	Females	Total
	48	52	50	61	39	50

Indicator 4.3.3 - Participation rate in technical and vocational education programmes (15-24-year-olds) by gender

Indicator 4.3.3	Participation rate (%) in technical and vocational education programmes by gender		
	Males	Females	Total
	1.5	0.6	1

To increase the enrolment rate in vocational education, the Ministry, through the General Directorate of Vocational Education, has taken the following measures:

1. Expanded opening of vocational specialties that provide the skills required in the labour market and reduce unemployment.
2. Undertaking investment projects with the private sector to invest in the assets of vocational schools and develop training in them in a way that guarantees sources to finance those schools, motivate their employees and students, and be of benefit to students as a pull factor.
3. Training for the unemployed, in coordination with the Ministry of Labour and Social Affairs. The first portion of preparation for training began in vocational education schools in all governorates and in various industrial, agricultural, commercial, arts and other specializations.
4. Participation of workers in the labour market and of employers in developing curricula and training in vocational schools to ensure that the latter keep pace with the latest developments in the market.

5. Investment in summer training for students to be in workplaces in the market, and training students to coexist with the market and on how to enter it with their own projects.
6. Follow-up of agricultural education graduates obtaining plots of agricultural land and granting them loans to establish their own agricultural projects and enter the labour market.

2. Programmes implemented relating to target 4.3

1. Establishment of scientific colleges, departments and branches in medical, engineering and science specializations and in the human sciences: 22 colleges, 95 departments and 55 branches during the period 2015-2018.
2. Establishment of new professional specializations in vocational education, including: medical devices, petrochemical industries, decorative arts, family education, tourism and hotel management, electronic management, phones and laptops.
3. Updating of the vocational education curriculum.
- 4 - Rehabilitation and training of vocational training entities, opening training workshops for students for new specializations and equipping them with supplies, devices and equipment.

Target 4.4 - By 2030, substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship

1. Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.4 (higher education)

Indicators	Value
Number of students and graduates who obtained jobs through university employment offices, 2018	1 631 students
Number of specialized courses in universities (2016-2018)	1 490
Number of participants in courses at universities (2016-2018)	5 027
Number of workshops (2016-2018)	7 438

2. Programmes implemented relating to target 4.4

- In the field of information and communications, projects and programmes were completed to provide technical skills to Ministry of Education employees.
- An e-learning project and the introduction of educational programmes and aids to enrich students of all academic subjects.
- Training courses to develop the capabilities of workers in using computers.
- Conducting International Certificate of Digital Literacy (ICDL) tests for employees and teachers in the Ministry of Education.

Indicator 4.4.1 - Percentage of youth and adults (aged 15-24 years and 15 and over) with information and communications technology (ICT) skills, by type of skill

Use of the Internet			Use of computer		
Type of skill	15-24	15 and over	Type of skill	15-24	15 and over
Send email	31.5	31	Transfer and copy a file	69	77
Internet phone call	84.2	85	Excel, Word and PowerPoint programmes	40	37
Stream and download photos, films and games	65.4	65	Use tools to copy and paste information within a document	41	34.5

Participate in social networks	62.5	64	Send email with attachments	25	32.5
Manage personal pages	49.5	43	Transfer files between a computer and other devices	34	26
Access chat sites	38	40			

Indicator 4.4.2 - Percentage of young people and adults with skills in digital technology, by skill type

1. The trend towards digital learning in curricula: the e-learning project for displaced and dropout students was completed in cooperation with UNICEF, whereby 24 e-books were completed that include 130 interactive electronic devices covering the primary level.
2. As a continuation of the development of pure science curricula (mathematics, sciences, and computer science), the two computer textbooks for the first and fourth secondary school grades for the 2019/2020 academic year have been completed, and work is currently under way on writing the textbooks for the second and fifth grade of secondary school. The mathematics textbook for primary school grade five has been completed, and currently a mathematics for grade six is being used in a sample of six schools in Baghdad Governorate.

Indicator 4.4.3 - The percentage of youth and adults according to age group, economic activity, level of educational attainment, and orientation of the educational programme (general - vocational - technical).

There are no values for this indicator. We will send them later if they are available, in coordination with the Ministry of Planning, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Target 4.5 - By 2030, eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations.

1. Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.5

Indicator 4.5.1 – Parity indices for all education indicators on this list that can be disaggregated

Indicator 4.5.1	Indicators of the gender parity factor in education					
	Primary education			Secondary education		
	Males/Females	With/Without disability	Rural/Urban	Males/Females	With/Without disability	Rural/Urban
	0.9	0.0026	0.53	0.8	Unavailable	0.27

Indicator 4.5.2 - The percentage of primary school pupils whose mother tongue is the language of instruction is 100%.

Indicator 4.5.3 - To what extent are there clear written political regulations for allocating resources to educating marginalized groups?

We will supply data for this indicator, if available, in coordination with the Ministries of Finance and Planning, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Indicator 4.5.4 - Agreement on education according to source of funding.

The estimated student quota for the academic year 2017-2018 is 835,490 dinars per student for the various educational levels.

2. Programmes implemented relating to target 4.5.

1. Special education. The Ministry of Education sponsors those with disabilities and special needs and ensures their education in order to integrate them into society. This type of education has seen a remarkable development in the number of schools covered by special education classes, including for slow learners, the hard of hearing, those with impaired vision and other disabilities, and the number of students and educational bodies.

Preparation of curricula for the deaf and mute segment to qualify such students to obtain a primary school diploma like their peers.

2. Preparation of the conditional cash transfer project with the Ministry of Labour and Social Affairs, with the support of the World Bank. To support poor families that receive current subsidies, whereby other subsidies are added to families that have students in schools for their continued studies and to reduce their dropout rate.
3. Ministry of Education action plan for students and educational and teaching staff in displacement and liberated areas:
 - With the support of UNICEF, a skills training manual for teachers has been prepared to help them overcome psychological, social and educational trauma and to enhance their capabilities in dealing with students.
 - With the support of UNICEF, a guide for extracurricular activities inside and outside the school has been prepared to help students re-adapt to society.
 - With the support of UNICEF, preparation of revised curricula with accelerated education textbooks for the displaced.
 - The great role of educational television programmes targeting displaced students, and the development of online curricula for the displaced in order to reach difficult places and those the Ministry could not reach.

Target 4.6 - By 2030, ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy

1. Current indicators (for 2018) for target 4.6.

Indicator 4.6.1 - Proportion of population in a given age group achieving at least a fixed level of proficiency in functional (a) literacy and (b) numeracy skills, by sex

You will be provided with the values of the above indicator once the appropriate statistical survey is conducted in cooperation with the Ministry of Planning - Central Bureau of Statistics.

Indicator 4.6.2: Literacy rate among youth / adults (national indicator: individuals over the age of 10 years who can read and write)	
(a) Males	91.9% *
(b) Females	82.1% **
National indicator: proportion of women aged 15-45 years who are literate	69% ***
Indicator 4.6.3: The value of the indicator (participation rate) is not available due to lack of data on illiterate individuals by age group. The number of illiterate youth and adults in general in the literacy programme for the academic year 2018-2019 was 77,525, distributed according to gender as follows:	
(a) Males	29 011
(b) Females	48514

*** Monitoring and Poverty Assessment Survey in Iraq, Ministry of Planning, 2018

*** Multiple Indicator Survey, Central Bureau of Statistics, 2018

2. Programmes implemented relating to target 4.6.

1. Adult education and lifelong learning programmes. The efforts made by the Ministry of Education consist in educating people who have not attended, did not complete or were left behind in primary education through:

- Accelerated education schools: for the 12-18 age group.
- Adolescent Schools: for the 10-15 age group.
- Your Right to Education centres for the 10-18 age group.

According to curricula appropriate to their ages.

2. Opening community education centres in a number of governorates, in addition to the opening of literacy centres to be parallel to the existing centres. The duration of study is seven months, starting from the opening date.

3. Approval of the General Secretariat of the Cabinet obtained for considering the literacy certificate a minimum for applicants to civil service posts. This entered into force in 2016.

4. Implementation of the Ministries Free from Illiteracy project in coordination with the literacy eradication councils in the governorates, in implementation of article 14 of the Literacy Act No. 23 of 2011.

5. Work to provide an opportunity for primary school graduates who are literacy graduates to complete their studies in evening lower secondary schools, in implementation of the principle of lifelong learning.

Target 4.7 - By 2030, ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture's contribution to sustainable development.

4.7.1 - Extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education; and (d) student assessment.

4.7.2 - Percentage of schools that provide life skills-based education on HIV and sexuality.

4.7-3 To what extent is the Universal Declaration of Human Rights framework applied at the national level?

4-7-4 Percentage of students by age group or school level who demonstrate an adequate understanding of issues relating to global citizenship and sustainability.

Given the exceptional circumstances the country is going through and the difficulty of obtaining data, the above indicators will be provided later if they are received from the relevant authority in our Ministry.

4.7.5 - Percentage of 15-year-old students who demonstrate proficiency in knowledge of environmental and earth sciences.

Males	Females	Total
9%	7%	8%

2. Programmes implemented relating to target 4.7

1. Include in the human sciences curricula at all levels of general education the issues of peace, rejection of violence, citizenship, and human, women's and children's rights.
2. Teaching human rights and democracy in all specializations in universities.
3. Creation of psychological and educational counselling units in universities.
4. Holding awareness and education workshops on sustainable development for a number of experts, departmental directors and officers in the Ministry of Education.
5. Life skills project to enhance positive behaviour and skills development in 11 governorates.
6. Positive education project to reinforce good behaviour and prevent violence.
7. Courses on human rights, peaceful coexistence, psychological support, crisis management and special education: 212 courses with the participation of 7,592 teachers.
8. Psychosocial support programmes for the liberated governorates (Nineveh and Anbar), with 2,138 trainees.
9. An e-learning project for displaced students, in cooperation with UNICEF, to provide educational opportunities for displaced students.

Target 4.a - Build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all.

Current indicators (2018-2019 academic year) for target 4.a.

National indicators	Academic year 2018-2019
Percentage of school buildings with health facilities for the 2018/2019 academic year	96.3%
Percentage of school buildings with safe drinking water	84.2%
Percentage of school buildings with sanitation services	75%
Percentage of school buildings equipped with electricity	100%
Percentage of schools equipped with the Internet	0
Percentage of schools equipped with computers	35%
Number of primary schools with special education classes	1 367
Percentage of schools with special education classes	9%

Target 4.b - By 2020, substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available.

There are no values for this indicator. We will supply them later if they are available, in coordination with the Ministries of Higher Education and Planning.

Target 4.c - By 2030, substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers, including through international cooperation for teacher training in developing countries, especially least developed countries and small island developing States.

Indicators of participation in training courses by instructors and teachers in training centres in Baghdad and the governorates for human and scientific specializations for the period 2015-2019 - the national indicator for target 4-c:

Place	Total courses	Total trainees
The training centre at the General Directorate of Preparation and Training	283	13 622
Governorate instructor training centres	6 100	189 318
Governorate teacher training centres	2 940	92 374

Challenges of achieving Sustainable Development Goal 4

Greatest challenges

1. Challenge of comprehensive data to measure progress towards achieving Goal 4 as, at the political level, there is confusion about the national statistical system, especially between the centre and the Kurdistan region, because there is a weakness in the institutional mechanisms linking efforts between the Central Bureau of Statistics and the Kurdistan Statistics Authority.
2. There are gaps in the educational levels in enrolment ratios, especially of females.
3. Illiteracy is still the biggest obstacle to building the educational system, with low enrolment rates for literacy centres.
4. The weak infrastructure of the basic education sector, the high percentage of schools operating on the double and triple system, and the difference in the capabilities of schools in terms of buildings, laboratories, and educational staff.
5. Weak agreement on education as a proportion of the state budget.